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Week 8 Lit Example Worksheet

MACBETH: FAIR, FOUL, AND SHIFTING SECURITY

Purpose: Apply Week 8's method to *Macbeth*. Expose shifting terms and retest the inference with fixed meanings.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not retell the whole plot.

Part 1: Fair and the Greetings

Question 1.1

In Passage 1, give two ordinary senses of *fair* that the language can carry.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

Which greetings are present facts, and which are future claims? Why does that difference matter for a stable argument?

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: From Sounding Fair to Acting

Question 2.1

Reconstruct the risky inference Macbeth may draw from the witches' words in a middle-term shape (even if informal). Name the term that is doing the linking work.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Explain why that link is an ambiguous middle or term shift rather than a stable proof that he must be king by crime.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Security Promises

Question 3.1

For “none of woman born shall harm Macbeth,” state Sense A (how Macbeth hears it) and Sense B (a different sense that later undercuts the guarantee).

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

For the Birnam wood promise, state Sense A and Sense B, then say whether Macbeth’s “That will never be” still follows under both fixed senses.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Repair

Question 4.1

Rewrite one of the security arguments with fixed meanings so that it no longer falsely guarantees Macbeth's safety.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

In one paragraph, explain how Week 8's tool changes a reading of these passages from "magic prophecy" to "unstable terms used as if they were proof."

Part 4 Q2